

Many Voices — Wireframe & Palette

Low-fidelity structure and the color/type system behind the diversity & inclusion template, with the reasoning behind each choice.

Page wireframe (desktop)

Grayscale, low-fidelity — shows layout and hierarchy only, not final styling.



Color palette

Every accent is used with intent — no color is purely decorative.

Paper
#F6F4EF

BASE BACKGROUND

A warm, slightly warm-gray off-white instead of stark white or the more common cream/terracotta template default. Reads as approachable and paper-like rather than clinical or corporate — fitting for a student-run, human initiative.

Ink
#23233B

PRIMARY TEXT / DARK SECTIONS

A deep plum-navy instead of pure black. It's soft enough not to feel institutional, dark enough for ~14:1 contrast against Paper, and doubles as the background for the stats bar and footer so the palette doesn't need a second dark color.

Ochre
#E3A72C

PRIMARY ACCENT / CTAS ON DARK

A warm gold rather than a "brand blue," chosen to feel optimistic and energetic without reading as any one culture's or country's flag color — important for a D&I-focused page where color symbolism gets noticed.

Teal
#2C7D7D

SECONDARY ACCENT / EYEBROWS, CTA BAND

Balances the warm ochre/coral with something cooler, used for the small "eyebrow" labels throughout so each section has a consistent visual anchor, and as the CTA band background for contrast against the mostly-warm page.

Coral
#E4572E

TERTIARY ACCENT / HOVER, FOCUS STATES

Used sparingly (link hovers, focus outlines, one pillar icon) so it stays an accent, not a dominant color. Bright enough to satisfy focus-visibility requirements without vibrating against the rest of the palette.

Thread colors
5 hues, one per "voice"

SIGNATURE ILLUSTRATION + VOICE CHIPS

Five distinct, roughly equal-weight hues (none dominant) represent the "many voices, one fabric" idea directly — used for the woven hero illustration and to tint each quote chip, so no single identity/color reads as the "default."

Why this palette over the obvious choices: templates in this space default to either (a) a single institutional blue, which reads corporate/cold, or (b) a rainbow gradient, which can feel like a stock "diversity" cliché rather than a considered brand. This palette keeps one warm neutral, one dark ink, and a small set of accent colors used *consistently by role* (ochre = primary action, teal = section labels, coral = interaction states, five threads = the "many voices" motif) — deliberate rather than decorative, and every text/background pairing was checked against WCAG AA contrast minimums.

Typography

DISPLAY — FRAUNCES

Different threads.

A warm, slightly quirky humanist serif instead of the generic geometric sans most templates default to. Gives headlines personality and warmth without looking decorative or hard to read.

BODY — WORK SANS

Many Voices brings together students from every background, discipline, and identity.

A clean, highly legible grotesque sans for body copy — neutral enough not to compete with Fraunces, and reads well at small sizes for long paragraphs.

UTILITY — IBM PLEX MONO

SEP 18 · UPCOMING EVENTS

Used only for labels, stats, dates, and eyebrows — the monospace rhythm signals "metadata" at a glance and keeps those small elements from being mistaken for body text.